

Image 3.1: Ram Chandra Kak, Prime Minister of Jammu and Kashmir (1945–47)
Source: Creative Commons

An emotional Nehru decided to personally rally around his protégé and close friend, Sheikh Abdullah. He first tried to persuade Kak to release Abdullah and when this failed, he decided to pay a visit to Kak in Srinagar and try and get him to agree. While crossing into Kashmir from Punjab, on 21 June 1946, Nehru was detained in Uri Dak Bungalow, under Kak's orders. This was a personal affront to Nehru, which made him very resentful; he resolved to bring Kak and the Maharaja down.[2] With Viceroy Lord Wavell's intervention, Nehru reached Srinagar a month later, in July 1946. He visited Abdullah in prison and attended one of his many trials. The Maharaja, however, declined to meet Nehru because he was very